MODULE 1 WORKSHEET

The Negotiator's Blueprint Planning Worksheet

Use this worksheet before your next real negotiation. It takes 15–20 minutes. Fill in the parts that help; skip the rest.

Negotiation I'm preparing for: _____
Date: _____

01 Behaviour self-check

How often do these describe you when the stakes are high? Circle a number (1 = rarely, 5 = very often). This is a reflection aid, not a scored test.

STATEMENT	BEHAVIOUR IT SUGGESTS	RARELY → OFTEN
I push hard and raise my voice to get my way.	Aggressive	1 · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5
I make demands or ultimatums early in the conversation.	Aggressive	1 · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5
I accept the first offer to avoid an awkward conversation.	Passive	1 · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5
I raise a need, then take it back ("never mind, it's fine").	Passive	1 · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5
I hint at what I want rather than saying it.	Manipulative	1 · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5
I use guilt or flattery to move the other person.	Manipulative	1 · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5
I state my needs clearly and give my reasons.	Assertive	1 · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5
I ask about the other side's needs before proposing a solution.	Assertive	1 · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5

My default under pressure is _____. The cost of that default is:

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02 Counterpart map and opening lines

What behaviour do you expect from the other side? Plan the flavour of assertiveness you'll use and write your actual words.

IF THEY ARE…	I'LL USE…	WHAT I'LL SAY (MY WORDS)
Assertive	Assertive	
Aggressive	Calm assertiveness	
Passive	Supportive assertiveness	
Manipulative	Transparent assertiveness	
Highly emotional	Grounded, empathetic assertiveness	
Passive-aggressive	Clear, firm assertiveness	

Remember: adjust tone, not values. Your anchor stays assertive whatever they do.

The one sentence I most need to say clearly in this negotiation:

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03 Strategy planner

Weigh the three factors from Lesson 5, then commit to a starting strategy and a backup.

Desired outcome

What do I want, and how important is it? (1–5)

Relationship

How important is the future relationship? (1–5)

Counterpart's position

Their needs, interests and potential leverage

Context

Time, resources, relationship dynamics

My strategy

☐ Competing ☐ Collaborating ☐ Compromising ☐ Avoiding ☐ Accommodating

I will use a _____ strategy, delivered with _____ behaviour, because _____.

If they change approach, my backup strategy is _____.

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04 MoSCoW issue list

Spend most of your preparation on the vital few. List every issue, then sort them. "Could" and "Won't" items are often useful trades.

Must
Deal-breakers

Should
Important, worth real effort

Could
Nice to have, possible trades

Won't
Not worth negotiating now

Trades I could offer (from my Could/Won't lists) in exchange for my Musts:

05 After-action review

Fill this in within 24 hours of the negotiation.

TEST	SCORE 1-5	EVIDENCE / WHAT I'D CHANGE
Wise agreement: did it meet the key interests of both sides?		
Efficiency: was the process a good use of time and energy?		
Relationship: is it better, the same, or worse?		

Behaviour I used / behaviour I meant to use. What made the difference?

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